

Diagonalization

Geometric Algorithms

Objectives

- » Finish our discussion on the characteristic polynomial
- » Motivate diagonalization via linear dynamical systems and changes of coordinate systems
- » Describe how to diagonalize a matrix

Keywords

multiplicity

similar matrices

diagonalizable matrices

change of basis

eigenbasis

Recap: Characteristic Polynomial

Recall: Determinants and Invertibility

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$$\begin{aligned} \det(A - \lambda I) = 0 &\quad \equiv \quad (A - \lambda I)\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0} \text{ has nontrivial solutions} \\ &\quad \equiv \quad \lambda \text{ is an eigenvalue of } A \end{aligned}$$

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How To: Finding Eigenvalues

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$$\det(A - \lambda I)$$

Example

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 4 & -3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A - \lambda I = \begin{bmatrix} 1-\lambda & -1 \\ 4 & -3-\lambda \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\det(A - \lambda I) = (1-\lambda)(-3-\lambda) - (-4)$$

$$= (\lambda - 1)(\lambda + 3) + 4$$

$$= \lambda^2 + 2\lambda - 3 + 4$$

$$= \lambda^2 + 2\lambda + 1 = (\lambda + 1)^2 \quad \boxed{\lambda = -1}$$

An Observation: Multiplicity

$$\lambda^1(\lambda - 1)^2(\lambda - 4)^1 \text{ multiplicities}$$

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Is the algebraic multiplicity meaningful?

Multiplicity and Dimension

Thm. The dimension of the eigenspace of A for the eigenvalue λ is *at most* the algebraic multiplicity of λ in $\det(A - \lambda I)$

The algebraic multiplicity is an upper bound on "how large" the eigenspace is

Practice Problem

$$\begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Determine the eigenvalues and an eigenbasis for the above matrix

eigenvalues of A
basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$

Answer

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\lambda = 1, 6$$

$$\mathbb{R}^2 = \text{span} \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

$$\det(A - \lambda I) = \det \begin{bmatrix} 5 - \lambda & 1 \\ 4 & 2 - \lambda \end{bmatrix} = (5 - \lambda)(2 - \lambda) - 4$$

$$A - I = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 1 \\ 4 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1/4 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{array}{l} x_1 = -1/4 x_2 \\ x_2 \text{ is free} \end{array}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -5 + 4 \\ -4 + 8 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} \Rightarrow \vec{v} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$$
$$= (\lambda - 6)(\lambda - 1)$$
$$\Rightarrow \lambda = 1, 6$$

Answer

$$\begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A - 6I = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 1 \\ 4 & -4 \end{bmatrix} \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$x_1 = x_2$$

x_2 is free

$$\vec{v} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5+1 \\ 4+2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 6 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix} = 6 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Motivating Diagonalization via Linear Dynamical Systems

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When can we describe any vector in $\mathbb{R}^n$ as a unique linear combination of eigenvectors of A ?

Recall: Linear Dynamical Systems

$$\mathbf{v}_1 = A\mathbf{v}_0$$

$$\mathbf{v}_2 = A\mathbf{v}_1 = A^2\mathbf{v}_0$$

$$\mathbf{v}_3 = A\mathbf{v}_2 = A^3\mathbf{v}_0$$

$$\mathbf{v}_4 = A\mathbf{v}_3 = A^4\mathbf{v}_0$$

$\vdots$

A **linear dynamical system** describes a sequence of **state vectors** starting at $\mathbf{v}_0$

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⋮

multiplying by
 A changes the
state

A **linear dynamical system** describes a sequence of **state vectors** starting at $\mathbf{v}_0$

demo

Eigenbases and Closed-Form solutions

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Given $\mathbf{v}_k = A\mathbf{v}_{k-1} = A^k\mathbf{v}_0$, if

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then

$$A^k \mathbf{v}_0 = \alpha_1 \lambda_1^k \mathbf{b}_1 + \alpha_2 \lambda_2^k \mathbf{b}_2 + \alpha_3 \lambda_3^k \mathbf{b}_3$$

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closed-form solution

$$A \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 3}$$

$$\lambda = 0, 1, 3$$

$$\vec{b}_1, \vec{b}_2, \vec{b}_3$$

$$A^k \vec{v}_0 = A^k (\alpha_1 \vec{b}_1 + \alpha_2 \vec{b}_2 + \alpha_3 \vec{b}_3)$$

$$= \alpha_1 A^k \vec{b}_1 + \alpha_2 A^k \vec{b}_2 + \alpha_3 A^k \vec{b}_3$$

$$= \alpha_1 0^k \vec{b}_1 + \alpha_2 1^k \vec{b}_2 + \alpha_3 3^k \vec{b}_3$$

$$\alpha_2 \vec{b}_2 + \alpha_3 3^k \vec{b}_3$$

Application: Eigenbases and Limiting Behavior

Thm. If A has an eigenbasis with eigenvalues

$$\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \dots \geq \lambda_k$$

then $\mathbf{v}_k \sim \lambda_1^k \mathbf{u}$ for some vector $\mathbf{u}$

The system grows exponentially in λ_1

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Given a basis $\mathcal{B}$ for $\mathbb{R}^n$, we only need to know how $A \in \mathbb{R}^n$ behaves on $\mathcal{B}$

Sometimes, A behaves simply on $\mathcal{B}$, as in the case of *eigenbases*

What we're really doing is changing our coordinate system to expose a behavior of A

Recap: Change of Basis

Recall: Bases define Coordinate Systems

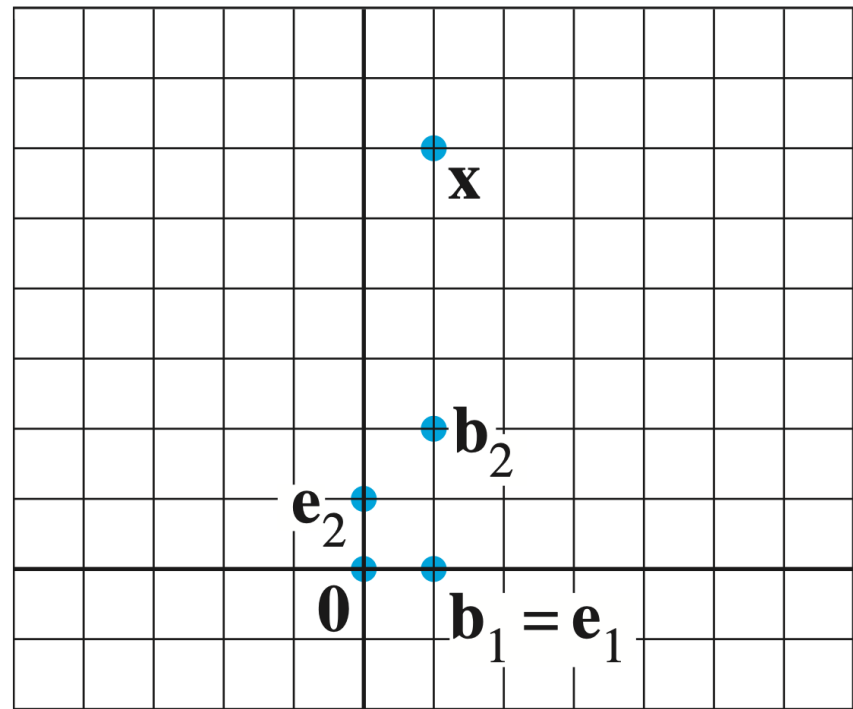


FIGURE 1 Standard graph paper.

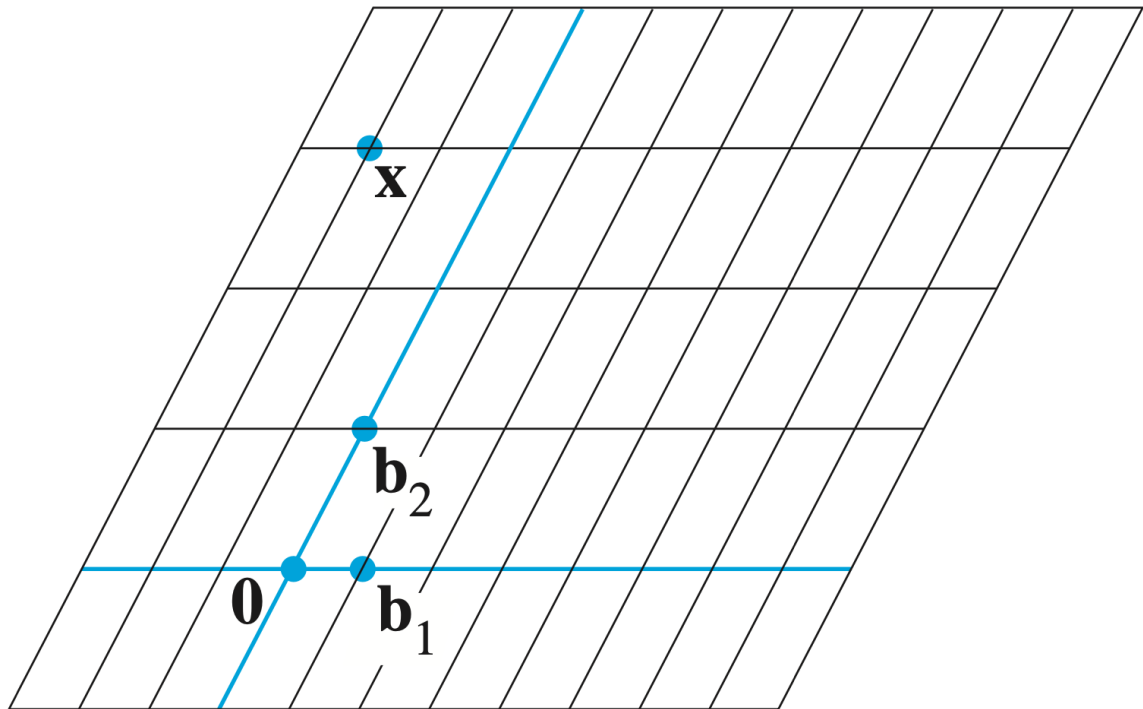


FIGURE 2 $\mathcal{B}$ -graph paper.

Recall: Bases define Coordinate Systems

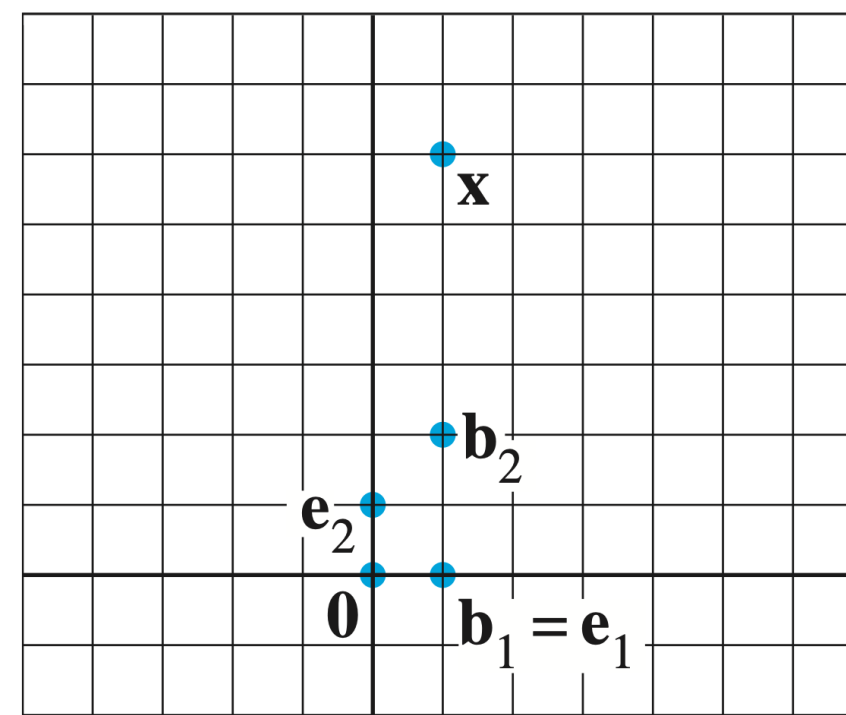


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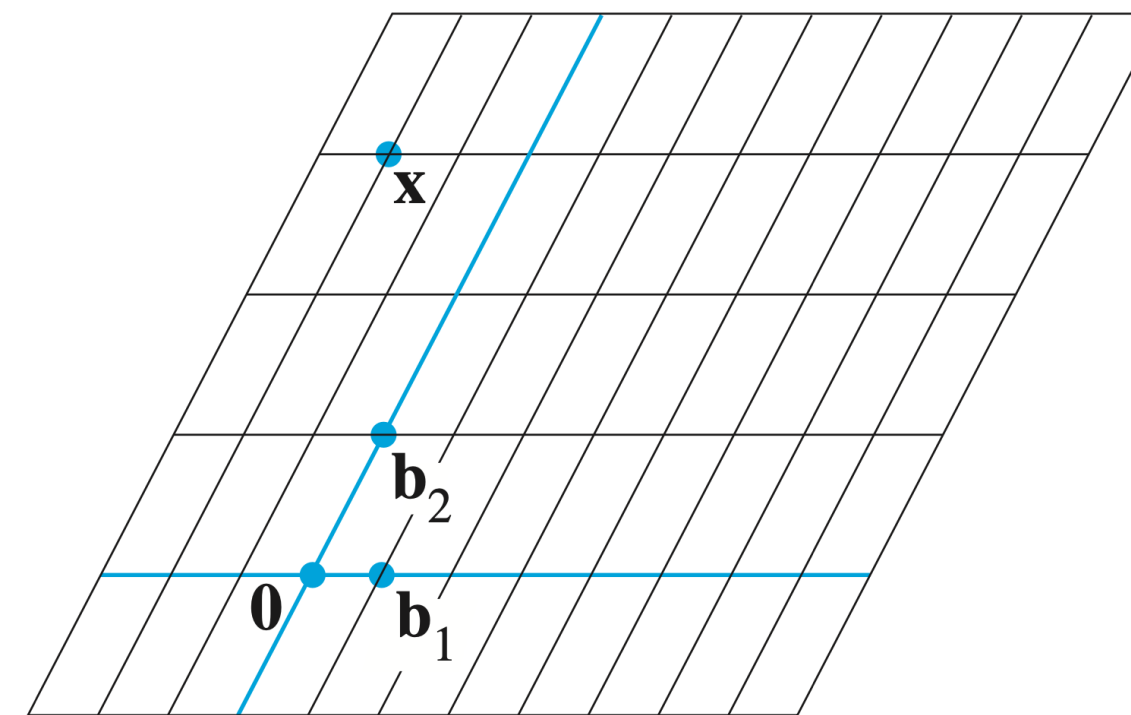


FIGURE 2 $\mathcal{B}$ -graph paper.

Given a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of $\mathbb{R}^n$, there is **exactly one way** to write every vector as a linear combination of vectors in $\mathcal{B}$

Recall: Bases define Coordinate Systems

$$\vec{x} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}$$

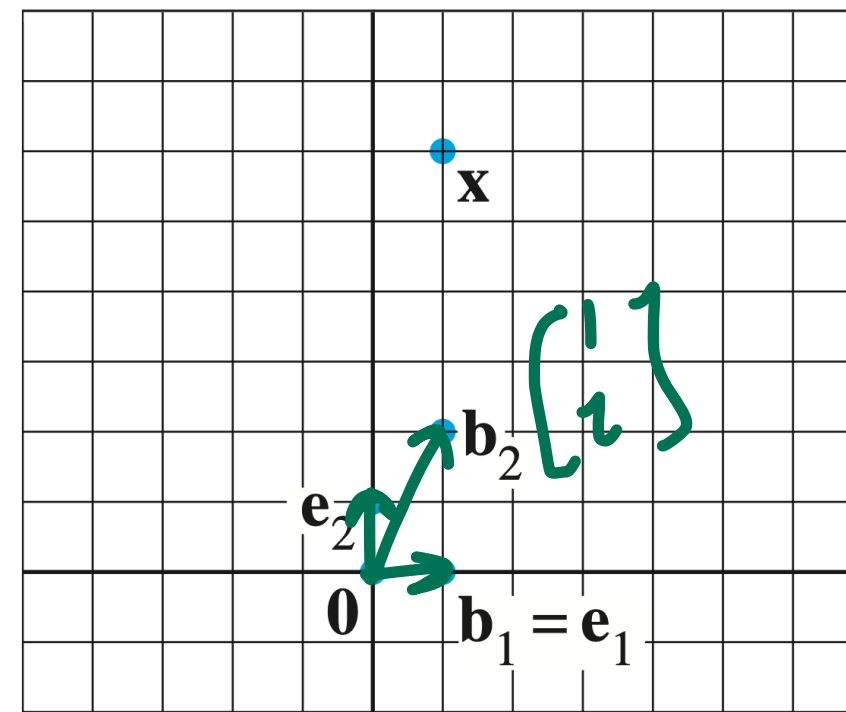


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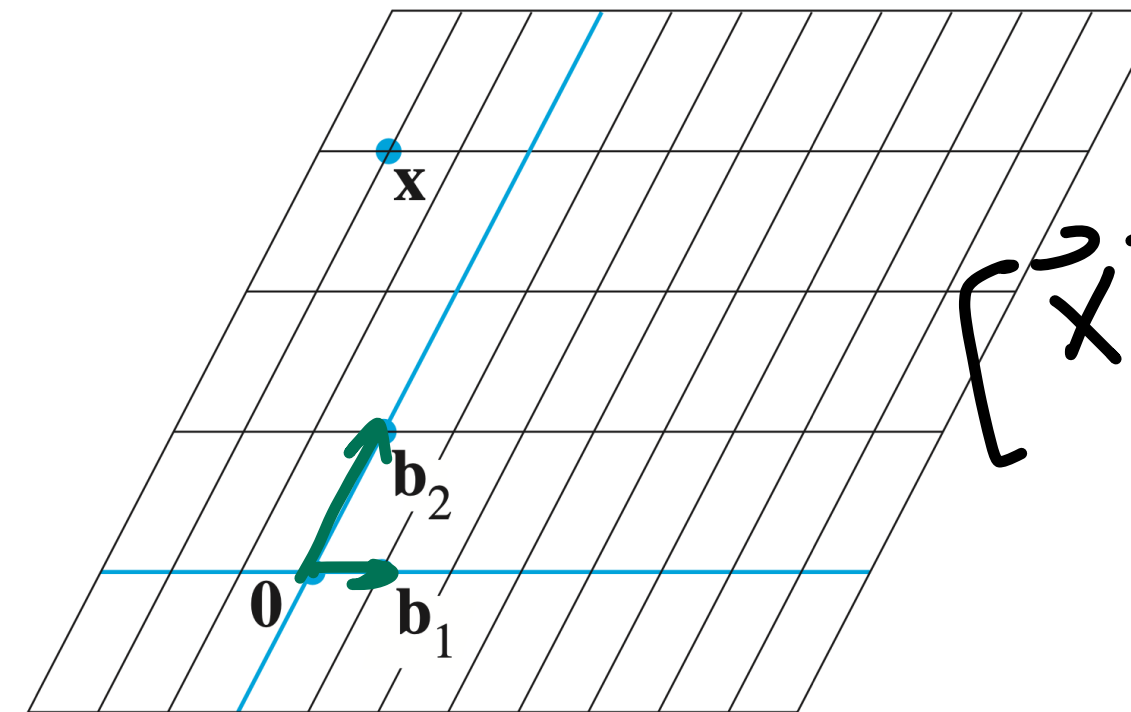


FIGURE 2 $\mathcal{B}$ -graph paper.

$$[\vec{x}]_{\mathcal{B}} = \begin{bmatrix} -2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\vec{x} = -2\vec{b}_1 + 3\vec{b}_2$$

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Every basis provides a way to write down *coordinates* of a vector

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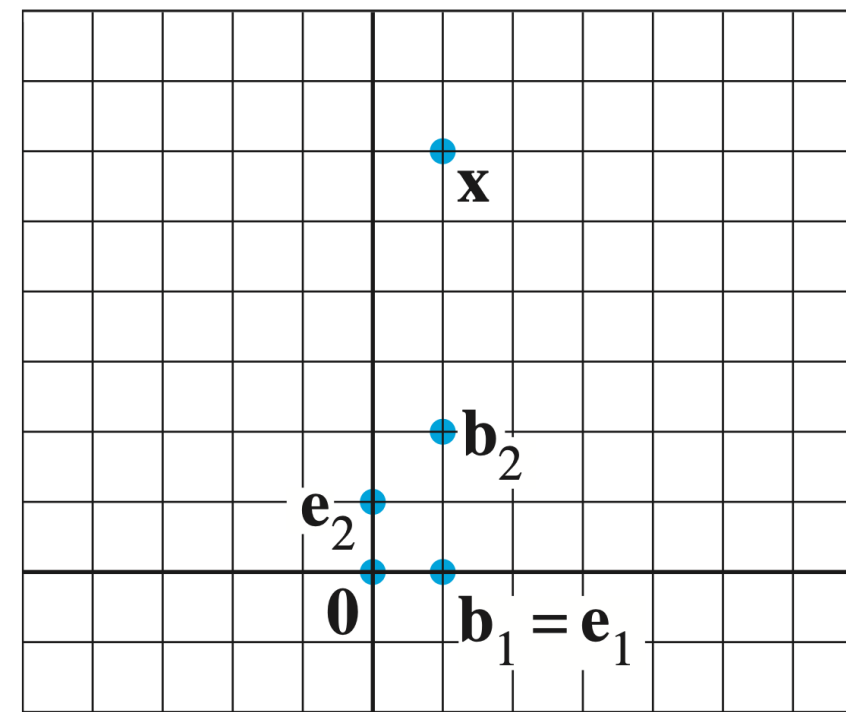


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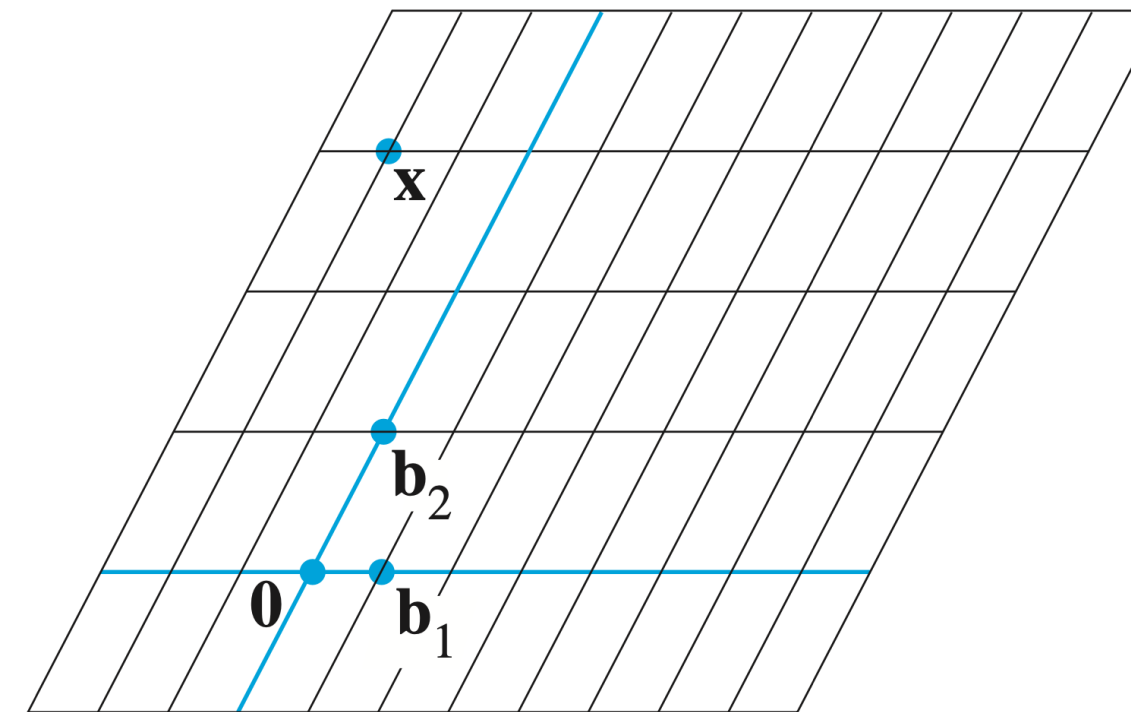


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$\mathcal{B}$ defines a "different grid for our graph paper"

Recall: Coordinate Vectors

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Let $\mathbf{v}$ be a vector in a $\mathbb{R}^n$ and let $\mathcal{B} = (\mathbf{b}_1, \mathbf{b}_2, \dots, \mathbf{b}_n)$ be a basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$ where $\mathbf{v} = a_1\mathbf{b}_1 + a_2\mathbf{b}_2 + \dots + a_n\mathbf{b}_n$

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$$[\mathbf{v}]_{\mathcal{B}} = \begin{bmatrix} a_1 \\ a_2 \\ \vdots \\ a_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$\vec{v} \mapsto [\vec{v}]_{\mathcal{B}}$
is linear

Question

We know that if a $n \times n$ matrix $B = [\mathbf{b}_1 \ \mathbf{b}_2 \ \dots \ \mathbf{b}_n] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is invertible, then the columns of B form a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of $\mathbb{R}^n$

What is the matrix that implements the transformation

$$\vec{e}_1 \mapsto [\vec{e}_1]_{\mathcal{B}}$$

$$\vec{e}_2 \mapsto [\vec{e}_2]_{\mathcal{B}}$$

$$\vdots$$

$$\mathbf{x} \mapsto [\mathbf{x}]_{\mathcal{B}} = \begin{bmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ \vdots \\ c_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$$T(\vec{e}_1) = \vec{b}_1$$

$$1\vec{b}_1 + 0\vec{b}_2 + \dots + 0\vec{b}_n$$

$$T(\vec{e}_2) = \vec{b}_2$$

where $\mathbf{x} = c_1\mathbf{b}_1 + c_2\mathbf{b}_2 + \dots + c_n\mathbf{b}_n$?

Change of Basis Matrix

Thm. If $\mathcal{B} = \{\mathbf{b}_1, \mathbf{b}_2, \dots, \mathbf{b}_n\}$ form a basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$, then

$$[\mathbf{x}]_{\mathcal{B}} = [\mathbf{b}_1 \ \mathbf{b}_2 \ \dots \ \mathbf{b}_n]^{-1} \mathbf{x}$$

Matrix inverses perform changes of bases

How To: Change of Basis

Q. Given a basis $\mathcal{B} = (\mathbf{b}_1, \mathbf{b}_2, \dots, \mathbf{b}_n)$ of $\mathbb{R}^n$, find the matrix which implements $\mathbf{x} \mapsto [\mathbf{x}]_{\mathcal{B}}$

A. Construct the matrix $[\mathbf{b}_1 \ \mathbf{b}_2 \ \dots \ \mathbf{b}_n]^{-1}$

Example

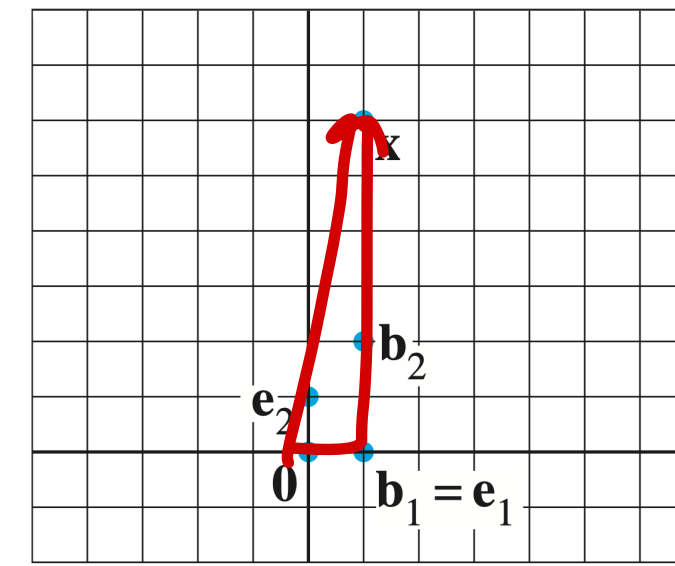


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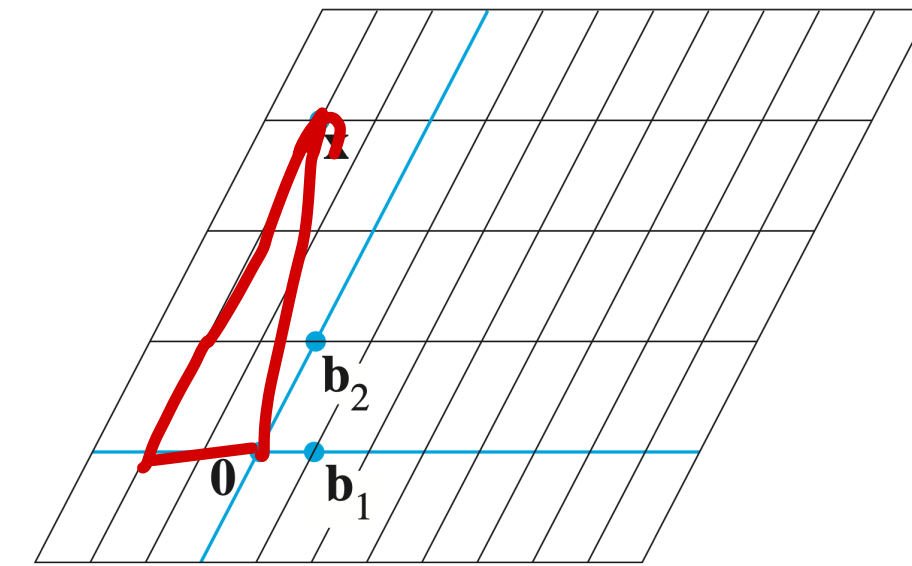


FIGURE 2 $\mathcal{B}$ -graph paper.

Write the change-of-bases matrix for the basis $\mathcal{B} = \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} \right)$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}^{-1} = \frac{1}{2 - 0} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1/2 \\ 0 & 1/2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1/2 \\ 0 & 1/2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 - 3 \\ 0 + 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

Diagonalization

Diagonal Matrices

ex.
$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -0.4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 22 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

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$i \neq j$ if and only if $A_{ij} = 0$

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Only the diagonal entries can be nonzero

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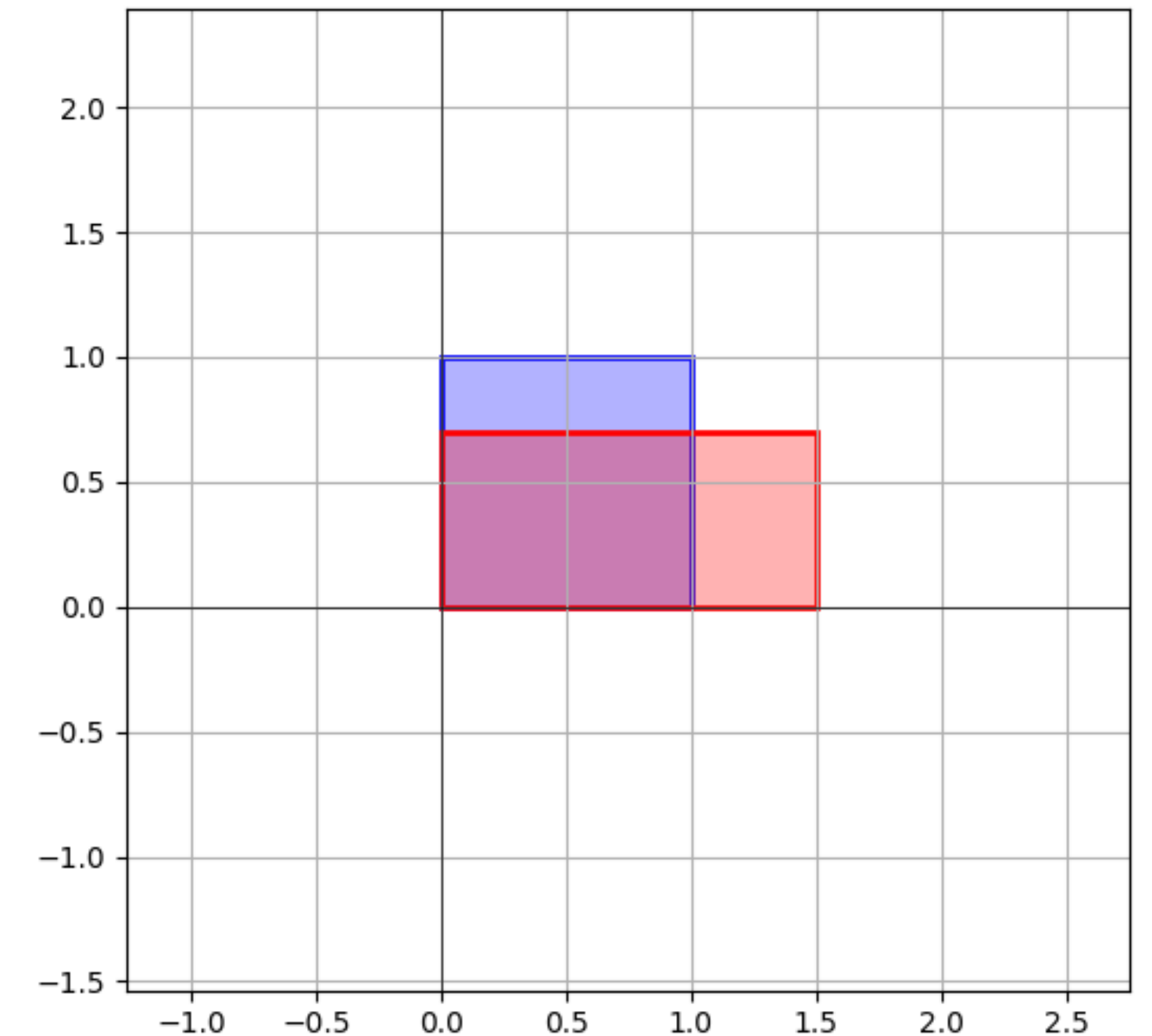
Diagonal matrices are scaling matrices

Recall: Unequal Scaling

The scaling matrix *affects each component of a vector in a simple way*

The diagonal entries scale each corresponding entry

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1.5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.7 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1.5x \\ 0.7y \end{bmatrix}$$



$$\begin{bmatrix} 1.5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.7 \end{bmatrix}$$

When do matrices "behave" like
scaling matrices "up to" change
of basis?

Scaling and Eigenvectors

Scaling and Eigenvectors

The idea. Matrices behave like scaling matrices on eigenvectors

$$\begin{bmatrix} c & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} c & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{bmatrix} (x \vec{e}_1 + y \vec{e}_2) \\ = x c \vec{e}_1 + y d \vec{e}_2$$

$$A (x \underline{\vec{b}}_1 + y \underline{\vec{b}}_2) = x A \vec{b}_1 + y A \vec{b}_2 \\ \text{eigenvectors} \quad = x \lambda_1 \vec{b}_1 + x \lambda_2 \vec{b}_2$$

Can we expose this behavior in terms of a matrix factorization?

Recall: Matrix Factorization

A **factorization** of a matrix A is an equation which expresses A as a product of one or more matrices, e.g.,

$$A = PBP^{-1}$$

Similar Matrices

$$A \sim B$$

$$\downarrow$$
$$B \sim A$$

$$(P^{-1}) A (P^{-1})^{-1}$$

$$A = P B P^{-1}$$
$$\Downarrow$$
$$P^{-1} A P = B$$

$$A = P B P^{-1}$$

change of basis

Def. A matrix A is **similar** to a matrix B if there is some invertible matrix P such that

$$A = P B P^{-1}$$

A and B are the same up to a change of basis

Similar Matrices and Eigenvalues

Thm. Similar matrices have the *same eigenvalues*

$$\text{Nul}(A - \lambda I) \ni \vec{r} \neq \vec{0} \qquad B = P A P^{-1}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \det(B - \lambda I) &= \det(P A P^{-1} - \lambda I) \\ &= \det(P A P^{-1} - P \lambda I P^{-1}) \\ &= \det(P (A - \lambda I) P^{-1}) \\ &= \cancel{\det(P)} \det(A - \lambda I) \cancel{\det(P^{-1})} \end{aligned}$$

Diagonalizable Matrices

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Diagonalizable matrices are the same as scaling matrices up to a change of basis

Important: Not all Matrices are Diagonalizable

This is very different from the LU factorization

We will need to figure out which matrices are diagonalizable

Application: Matrix Powers

Thm. If $A = PBP^{-1}$, then $A^k = P$ ^{only take the power of B} B^kP^{-1}

It may be easier to take the power of B (as in the case of diagonal matrices)

$$\begin{aligned} A^2 &= PBP^{-1}PBP^{-1} \\ &= PB^2P^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

But how do we find the
diagonalization...

Diagonalization and Eigenvectors

Suppose we have a diagonalization

$$A = PDP^{-1}$$

What do we know about it?

Columns of P are eigenvectors

$$A = [\mathbf{p}_1 \ \mathbf{p}_2 \ \mathbf{p}_3] \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \lambda_3 \end{bmatrix} [\mathbf{p}_1 \ \mathbf{p}_2 \ \mathbf{p}_3]^{-1}$$

$$P D P^{-1} \vec{p}_1 = P D \vec{e}_1 = P \lambda_1 \vec{e}_1 \\ = \lambda_1 \vec{p}_1$$

Columns of P are eigenvectors

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In fact, the columns of P form an **eigenbasis** of $\mathbb{R}^n$ for A

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In fact, the columns of P form an **eigenbasis** of $\mathbb{R}^n$ for A

And the entries of D are the **eigenvalues** associated to each eigenvector

Columns of P are eigenvectors

$$A = \overset{\text{eigenbasis}}{[p_1 \ p_2 \ p_3]} \overset{\text{eigenvalues}}{\begin{bmatrix} \lambda_1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \lambda_3 \end{bmatrix}} [p_1 \ p_2 \ p_3]^{-1}$$

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A diagonalization exposes a lot of information about A

The Diagonalization Theorem

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We can use the same recipe to go in the other direction, given an eigenbasis, we can **build a diagonalization**

Diagonalizing a Matrix

High Level

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The diagonal of D are the eigenvalues for each column of P

The matrix P^{-1} is a change of basis to this eigenbasis of A

Step 1: Eigenvalues

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Find all the eigenvalues of A

Find the roots of $\det(A - \lambda I)$

e.g. $\det(A - \lambda I) = -(\lambda - 1)(\lambda + 2)^2$

Step 2: Eigenvectors

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\lambda_1 = 1$$

$$\lambda_2 = -2$$

Find **bases** of the corresponding eigenspaces

e.g.

$$\text{Nul}(A - I) = \text{span} \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

$$\text{Nul}(A + 2I) = \text{span} \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

Step 3: Construct P

If there are n eigenvectors from the previous step they form an **eigenbasis**

Build the matrix with these vectors as the columns

e.g.

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\lambda_1 = 1$$

$$\lambda_2 = -2$$

$$\text{Nul}(A - I) = \text{span} \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

$$\text{Nul}(A + 2I) = \text{span} \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

Step 5: Construct D

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\lambda_1 = 1$$

$$\lambda_2 = -2$$

Build the matrix with eigenvalues as diagonal entries

Note the order. It should be the same as the order of columns of P

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

e.g. $1 > -2 \geq -2$

$$D = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 6: Invert P

Find the inverse of P

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$D = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Putting it Together

A

P

D

P^{-1}

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 3 \\ -3 & -5 & 3 \\ 3 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}^{-1}$$

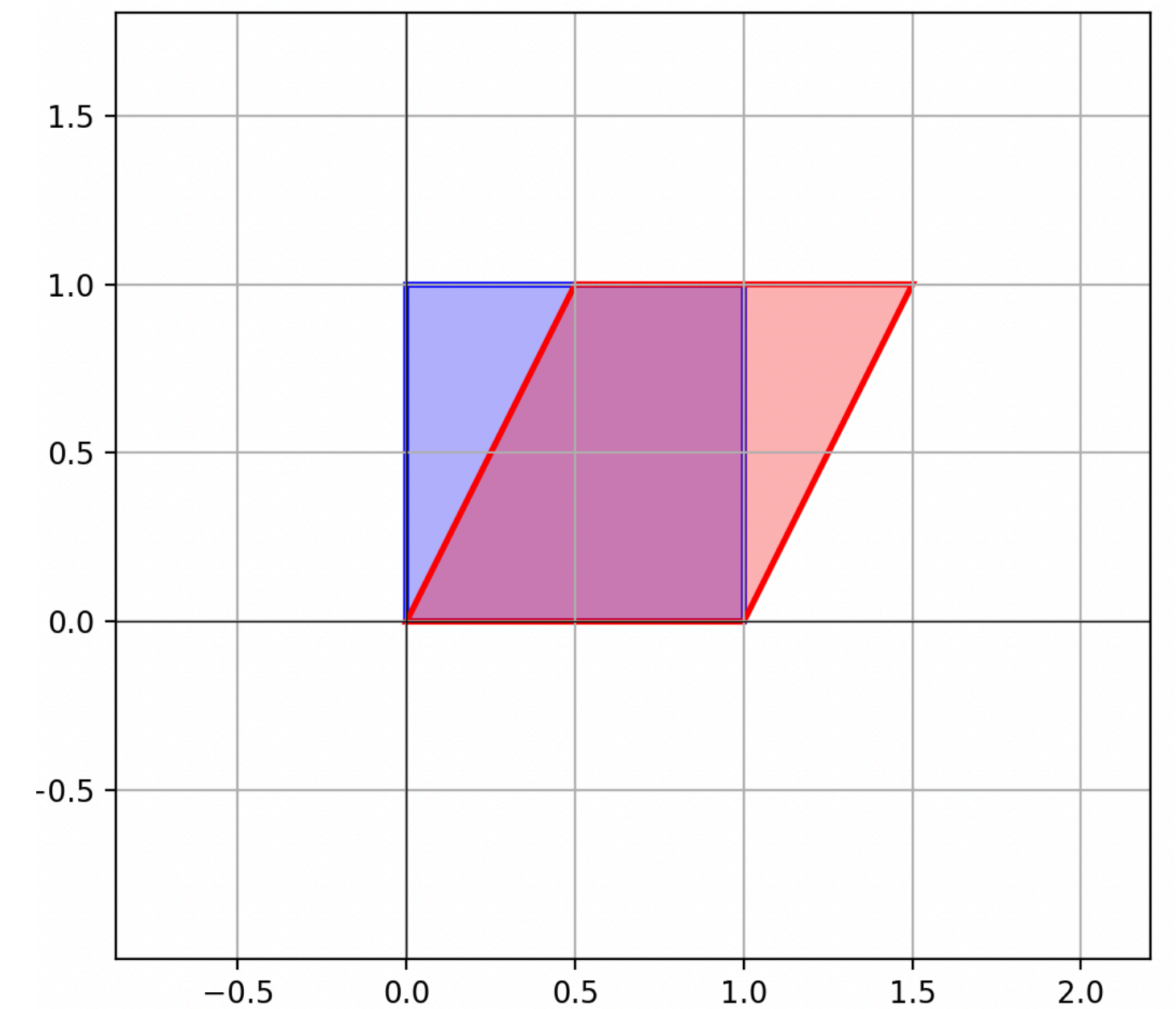
We know how to do every step, its
a matter of putting it all
together

Example of Failure: Shearing $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0.5 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

The shearing matrix has a single eigenvalue with an eigenspace of dimension 1

We can't build an eigenbasis of $\mathbb{R}^2$ for A

In other words, A is not diagonalizable



Important case: Distinct Eigenvalues

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -3 & 4 & 2 \\ 0 & -2 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 10 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 6 \end{bmatrix}$$

Thm. If a matrix in $\mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ has n distinct eigenvalues, then it is diagonalizable

This is because eigenvectors with distinct eigenvalues are *linearly independent*

Example

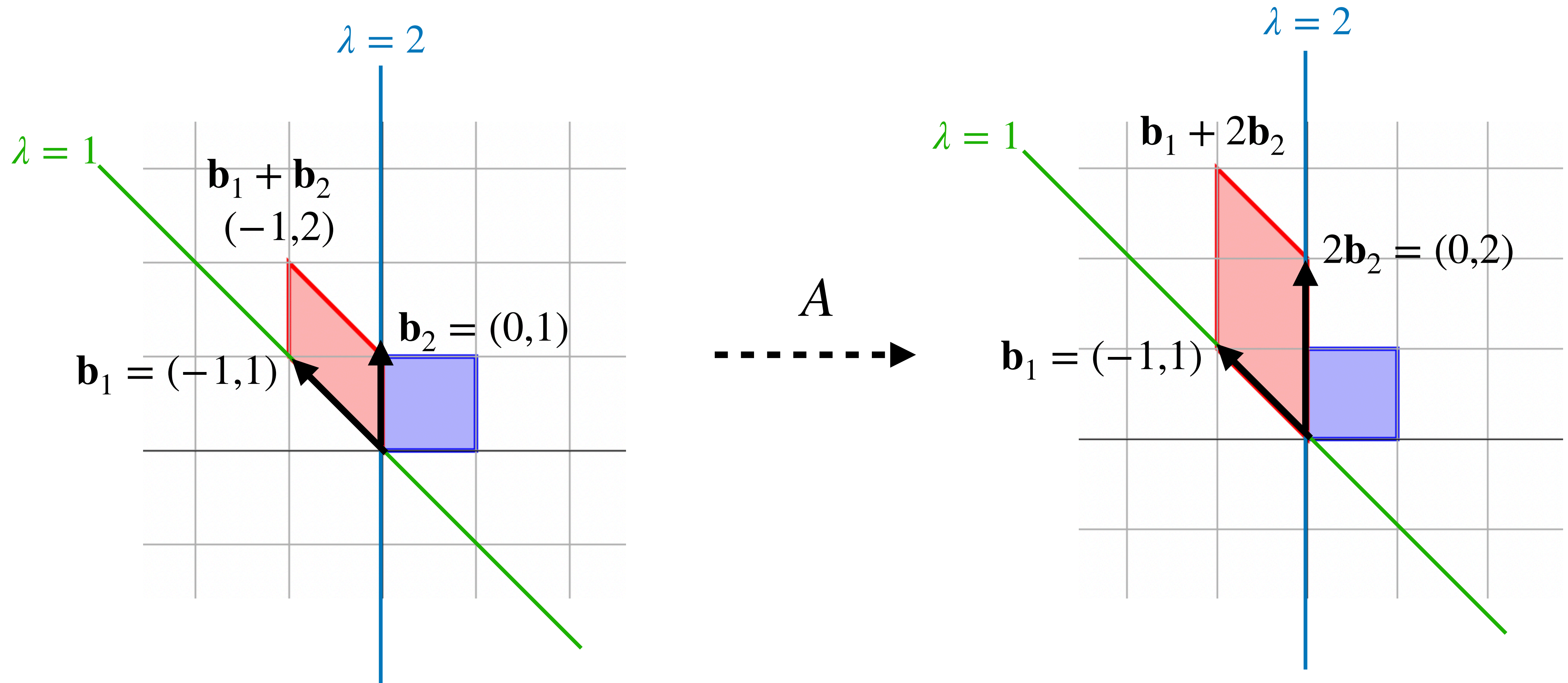
$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Find a diagonalization of the above matrix

The Picture

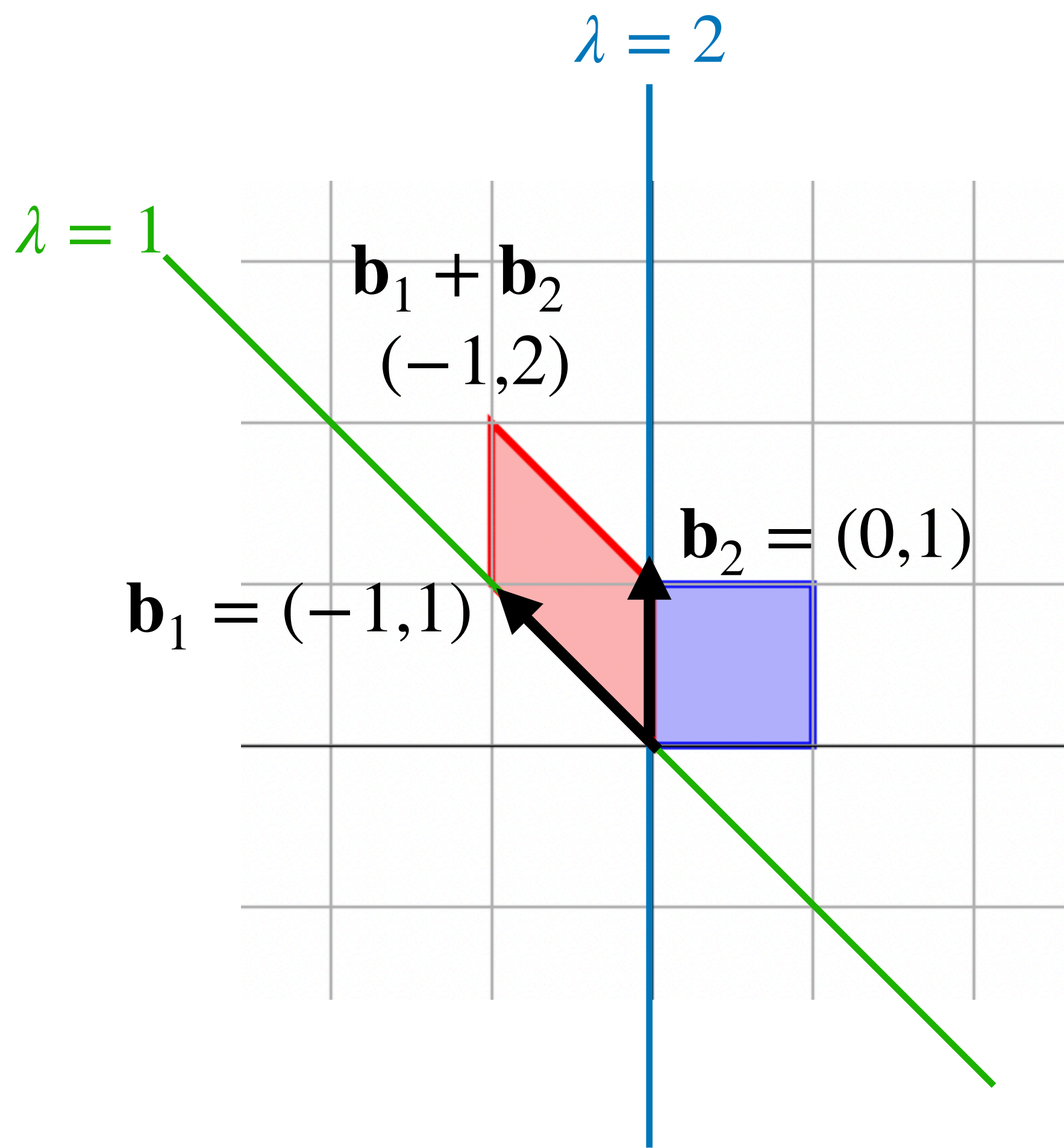
Example (Geometric)

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

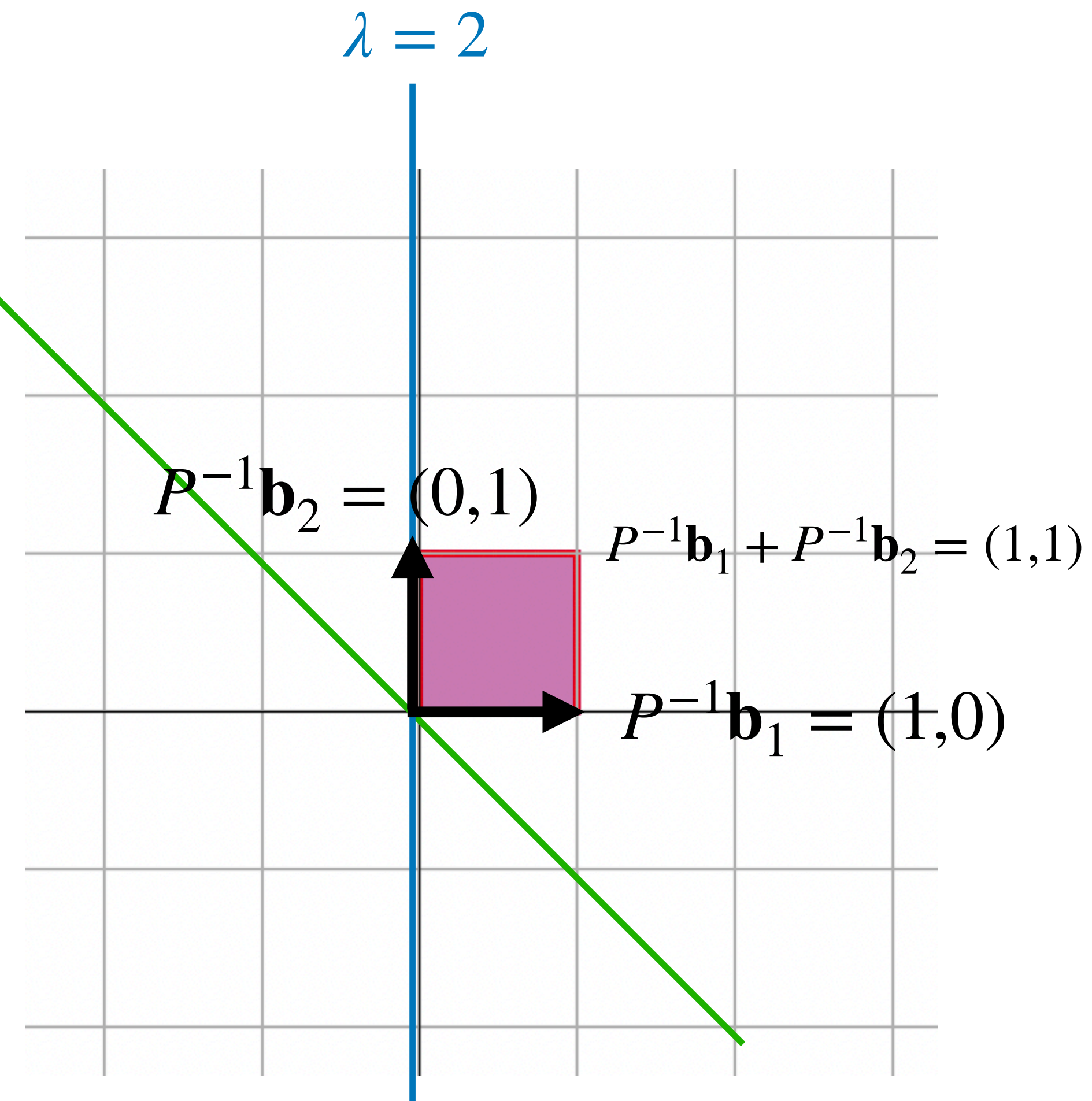


Example (Geometric)

$$P^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}^{-1}$$

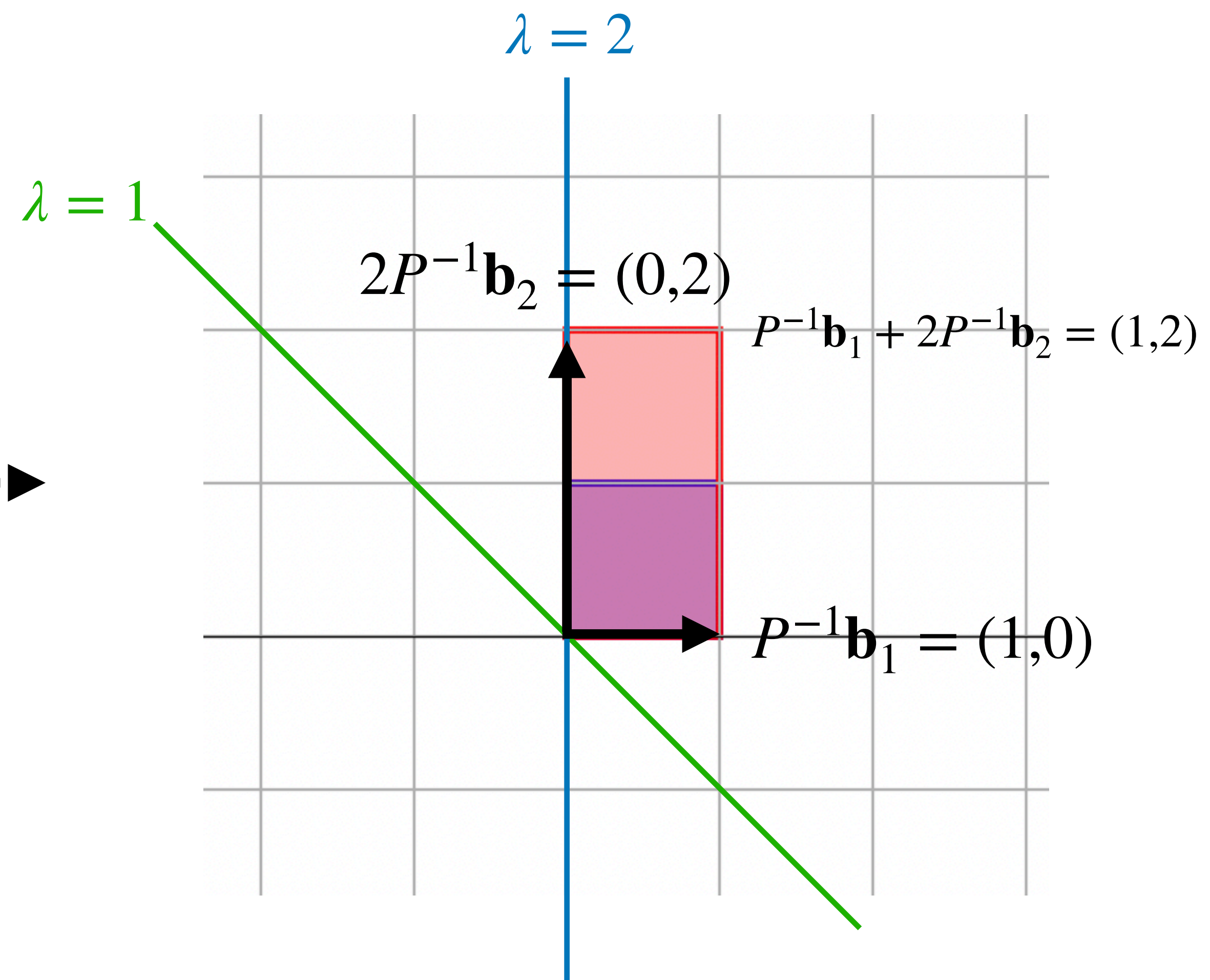
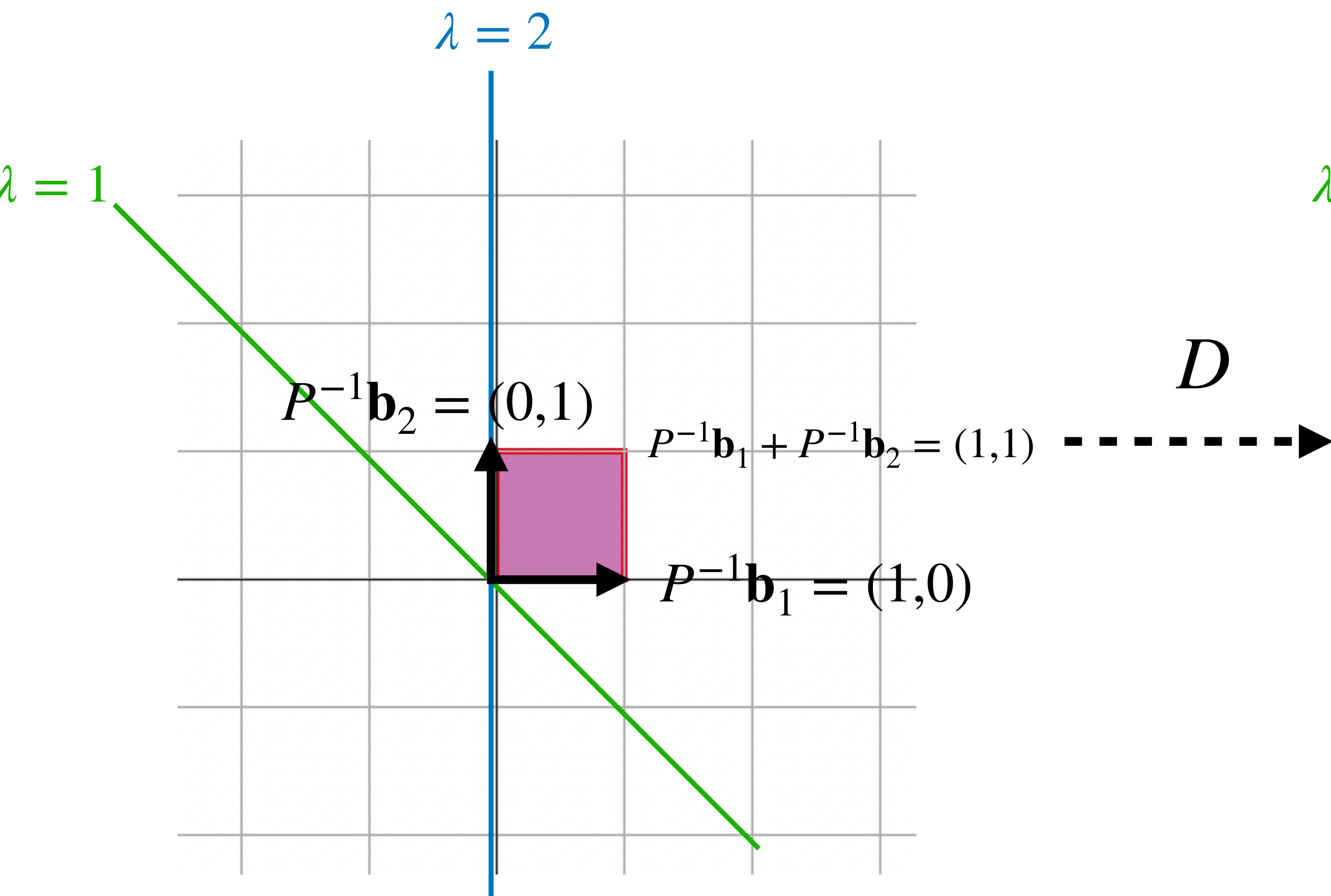


P^{-1}



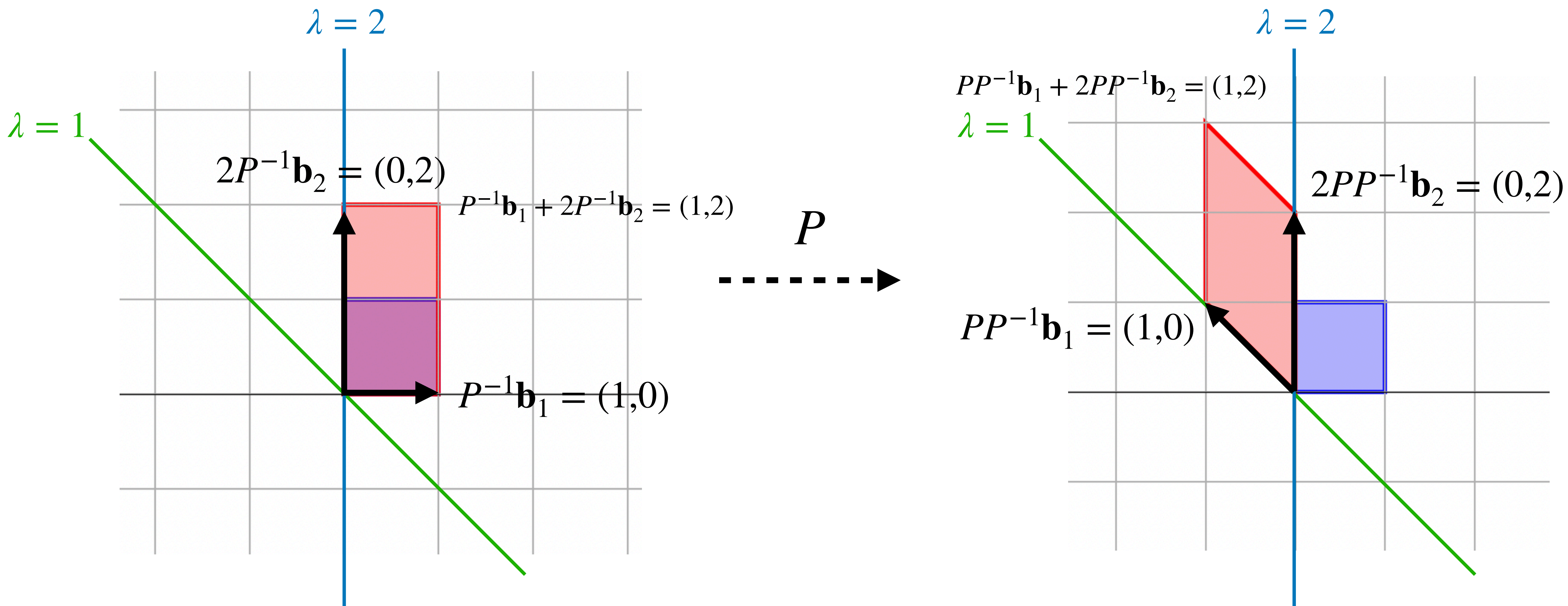
Example (Geometric)

$$D = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

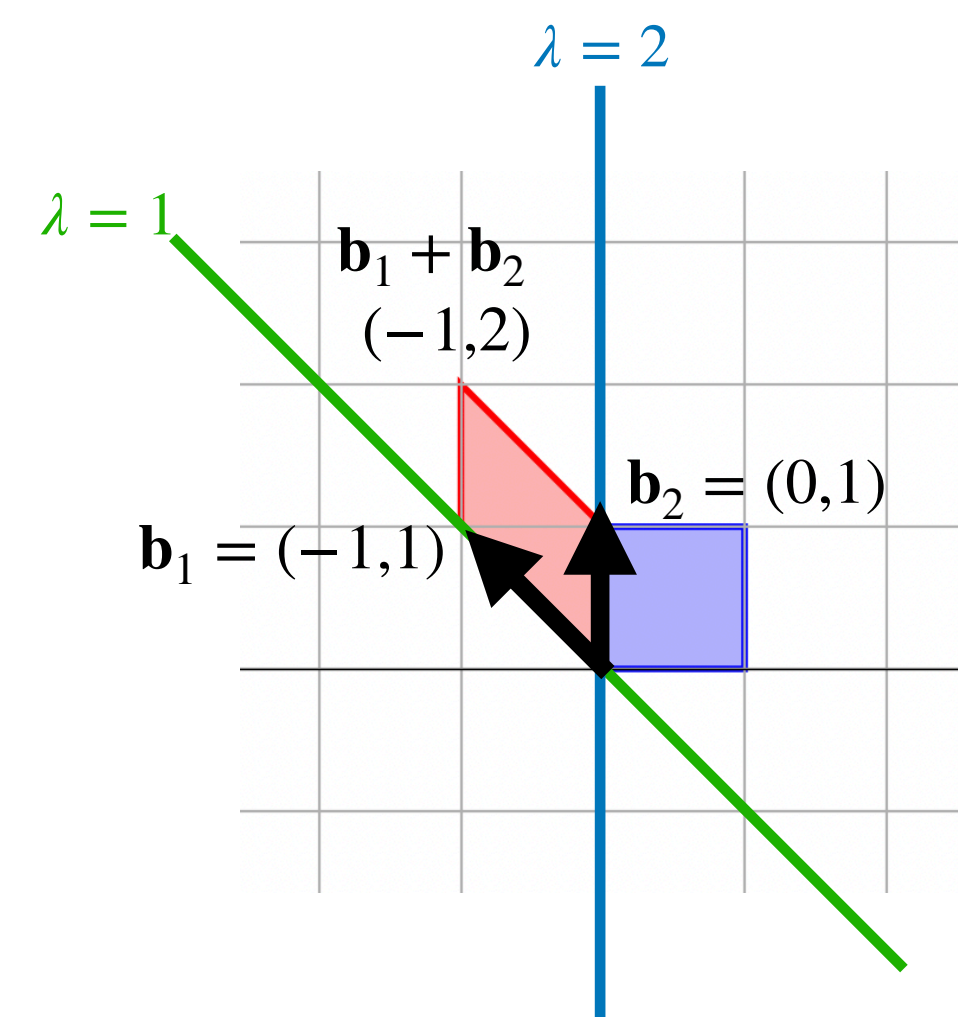


Example (Geometric)

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

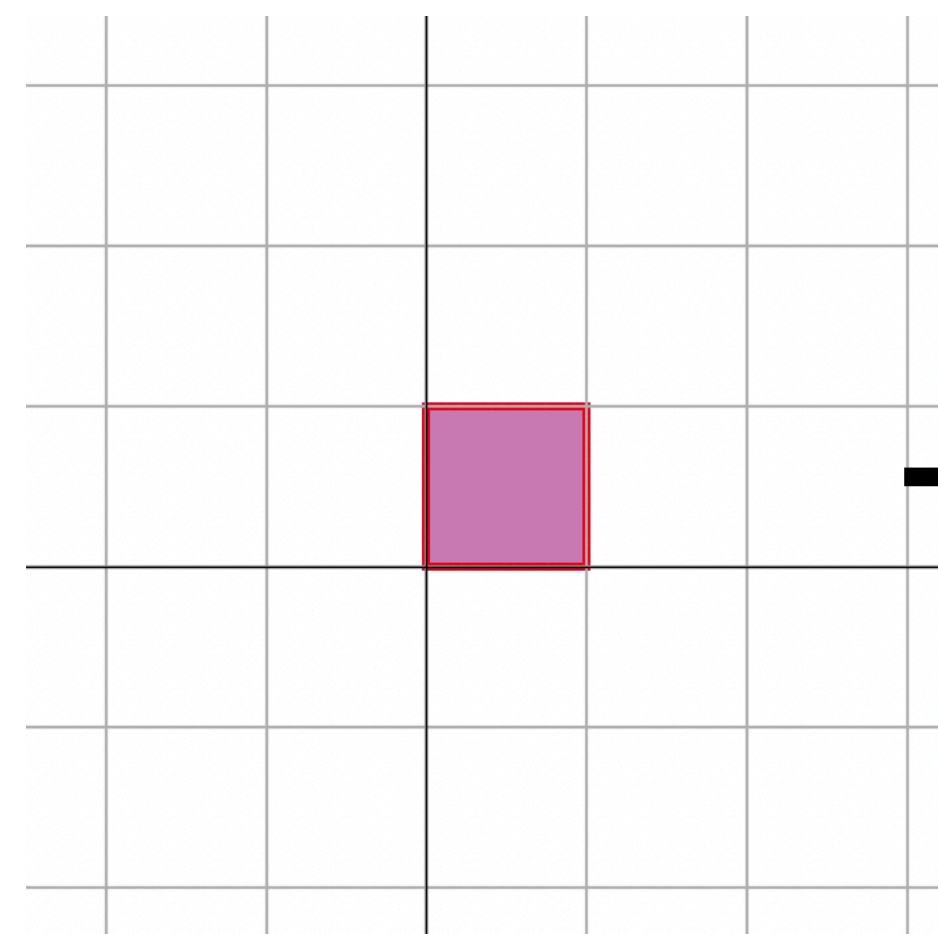


Example (Geometric)

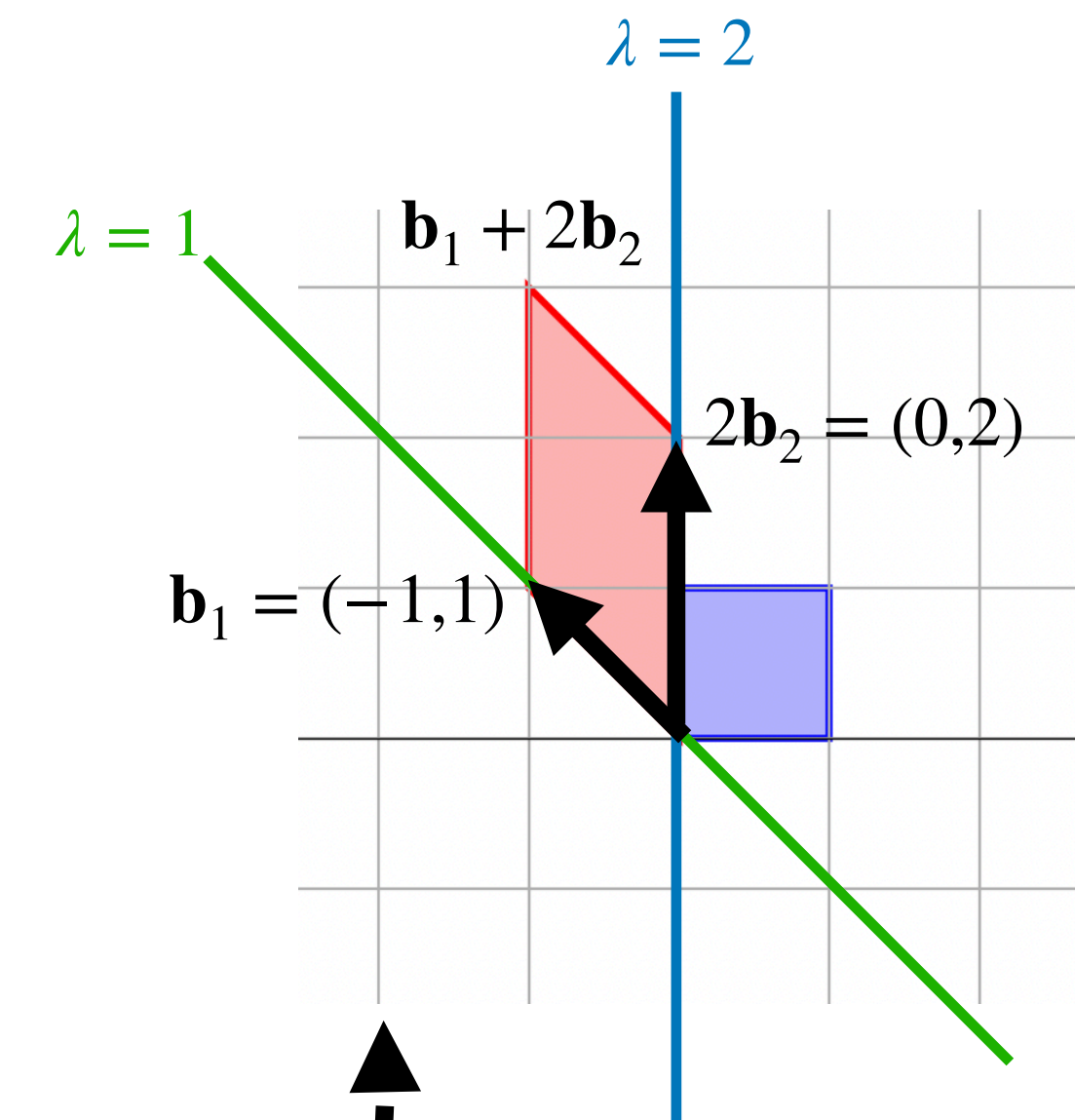
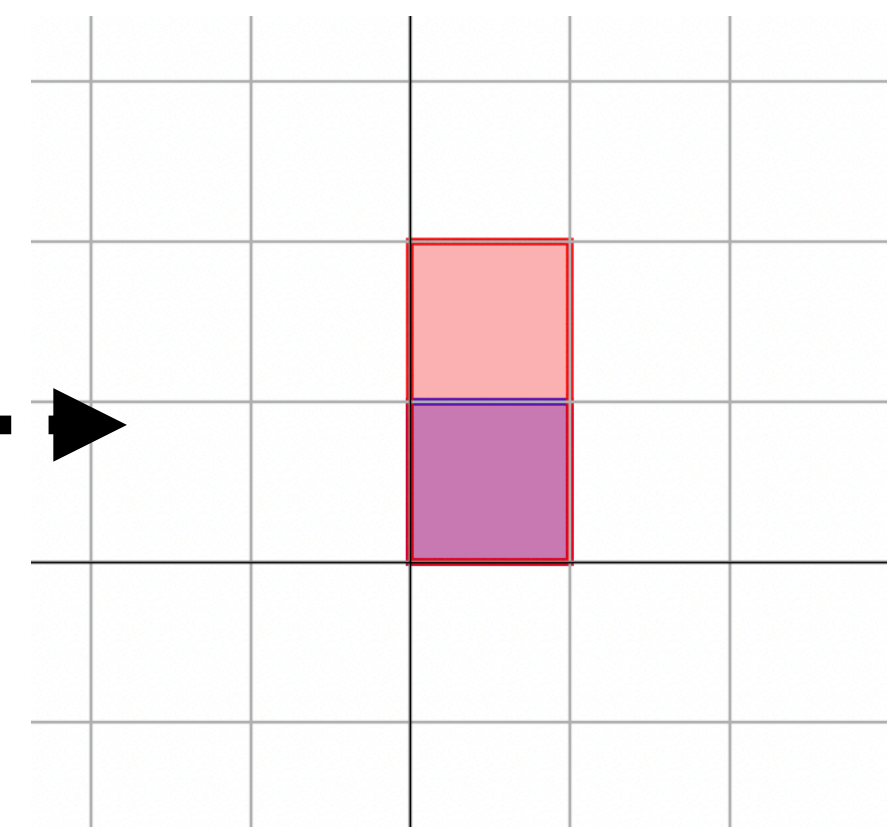


$$A = PDP^{-1}$$
$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}^{-1}$$

P^{-1}



D



P